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OnePlus Buds

Average for the most part, good for OnePlus users

B

uilding upon OnePlus' relatively impressive range of audio products,

OnePlus' first entrant into the burgeoning true wireless segment is the OnePlus Buds. Priced pretty competitively at Rs 4,990, the earphones are reminiscent of AirPods due to its half in-ear design that casts away silicone tips. Let's delve into our review to see how the OnePlus Buds fare.

Build and comfort

The OnePlus Buds have adopted the one-size-fits-most approach, and while a large number of people do find this half-in-ear fit adequately secure and comfortable, some folks with odd-shaped ear canals or smaller ones are out of luck. Another negative of the half in-ear design is that passive isolation, more often than not, takes a hit.

Going past the half in-ear design, the charging case of the OnePlus Buds is diminutive and pocketable. The front of the case houses a tiny LED, there's a USB-C port at the bottom and a pairing button at the back side of the oval, relatively flat case. The earphones come equipped with wear-detection which works pretty well. The rear housings of the Buds feature a CD-like pattern which also doubles as a touch sensor. Non-OnePlus users can only use this touch control to move to the next track by double-tapping, which is alarmingly limiting. On OnePlus devices, the double-tap can be customised.

Features

In addition to the touch controls and wear detection we mentioned, the OnePlus Buds also come equipped with features such as Bluetooth 5.0, SBC and AAC codec support (no aptX sadly), IPX4 rating, Fast Charging, Google Fast Pair and Mono mode. With OnePlus devices, you get access to a wider



Price
₹4,990

array of features such as Dolby Atmos support with supported OnePlus devices, and Dirac Audio Tuner support on OnePlus Nord devices.

You also get to experience super low-latency mode of 103ms in Fnatic Mode on OnePlus devices.

It is disappointing that other smartphone users cannot make use of a wide array of alluring features on these Buds seeing that ones such as the Realme Buds Air Pro allow features such as low-latency support and customisable controls on all devices, and they naturally become the more value for money purchase for users.

Performance

The OnePlus Buds' sound quality is nothing to write home about, but it is pretty consumer-friendly. The 13.4mm dynamic drivers aggressively push bass notes to compensate for the sometimes flimsy half in-ear fit and the resulting isolation. However, this bias, which is clearly heard in tracks such as *Uptown Funk* by Bruno Mars, can veil the mids and vocals at times. There isn't too much detail in any range of the frequencies but there's certainly a thumping drive in the bass and lows that may appease bassheads.

The vocals are decently reproduced, but some tracks such as *Sour Candy* by Melt shows a lack of clarity in some parts of the vocals, especially at the

1.33 mark. Nevertheless, the bass isn't muddy or distorted which makes for an overall decent listening experience. High-resolution FLAC music files, however, bring out some of the missing detail that would otherwise be absent via streaming services such as Spotify.

Now, coming to the microphone, the quality was excellent and they relayed clear, accurate audio and combated background noises pretty decently.

Battery life

OnePlus claims that the OnePlus Buds are capable of a whopping 30 hours of battery life with the charging case and

buds combined, while the buds themselves have a playtime of about 7 hours. In our tests, at

about 50 percent volume and AAC codec active, we achieved a playtime of about 6 and a half hours, which is pretty close to the estimate.

The Buds are capable of Fast Charging where

10 minutes of charging will top up the earphones enough to amount to 100 minutes of playtime. The case also Fast Charges, where 10 minutes of charging yields 10 hours of battery life.

Bottomline

Priced at ₹4,990, the OnePlus Buds are attractive on paper. However, a number of alluring features on these buds are reserved for OnePlus users only. If you can make do with the limited controls, these earphones provide you with decent sound, good battery life, and Fast Charging abilities.

—Dhriti Datta

SPECIFICATIONS

PRODUCT COLOURS: White/Gray/Nord Blue | WEIGHT: Earbud: 4.7 g, Charging box: 37 g | DRIVER: 13.4 mm dynamic | FREQUENCY RESPONSE RANGE: 20 Hz - 20 KHz | BLUETOOTH VERSION: 5.0 | WIRELESS RANGE: 10 meters | CHARGING: USB Type-C | TIME TO FULLY CHARGE: Earbuds+Charging box: 80 mins | PLAYTIME: Up to 7 hours (music playback), 4 hours (phone call), Up to 30 hours (with charging case) | FAST CHARGE: 10 mins for 10 hours (charging box+earbuds) | 10 mins for 2 hours playtime for the earbuds

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